



Starfield: Ghost Ocean Liner

Version 1.0

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Document Revisions Table

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1.0	Initial Document	Professor Stephens/Professor Porter	6/1/2026

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
Table of Figures	3
Level Summary	4
Quick Summary	4
Level Feature Overview	4
Development Schedule	4
Level Overview	6
Overview Map	6
Level Details	7
Detail Maps	7
Section 1: Deck Area	7
Section 2: Bridge Area	9
Section 3: Passenger Area	10
Section 4: Crew Area	11
Section 5: Event Area	12
Section 6: Cargo Area	13
Skill Progression Chart	14
Aesthetic References	15
Visual Theme 2: Industrial spaceship interior	16
References	17
Appendices	18
Appendix B: Context Detail	18
General Context	18
Backstory	18
Aftermath	18
Appendix E: Development Risks	19
Appendix F: Key Asset Needs	20

Table of Figures

Figure 1: Overview Map.....	6
Figure 2: Deck area.....	7
Figure 3: Bridge Area.....	9
Figure 4: Passenger Area.....	10
Figure 5: Crew Area.....	11
Figure 6: Event Area.....	12
Figure 7: Cargo Area.....	13
Figure 8:Luxury ocean liner style 1	15
Figure 9: Luxury ocean liner style 2	15
Figure 10: industrial spaceship style 1	16
Figure 11: Industrial spaceship interior 2	16

Level Summary

Quick Summary

Ghost Ocean Liner is a single player side quest in Starfield. While traveling through space, the player runs out of fuel; in a desperate bid to refuel, they board a passing ocean liner at the very last moment—only to discover that nothing remains inside but wreckage and ruins. As the player ventures deeper into the vessel, they uncover evidence suggesting that some form of creature was responsible for killing everyone on board. However, as their exploration progresses, the player will unearth an even greater secret.

Level Feature Overview

Category	Sub-Category	Feature List
Player	Player Weapons	Distance • Grendel • Ember Melee • Rescue axe
	Player Skills/Abilities	• Hacking • Lockpicking • Pickpocket
AI	Enemies	• Terrormorph • Xenogrub
	Friendlylies	• N/A
Challenges	Gameplay Themes	• Environmental storytelling • Stealth • Chase and run • Puzzling
	Obstacles/Hazards	• Battery and light puzzles • Ventilation tubes • Secret doors
	New/Unique Gameplay	• Secret doors
Context	Where Fits in Game	• A random place in the space
	Challenge Fit	• Midterm
	Additional Info	• An ALIEN like story
Aesthetics	Major Visual Themes	• Luxury ocean liner ruins • Industrial-style Spaceship Interior • Alien-style Ruins
	Setting/Mood	• Terrifying • Heavy

Development Schedule

Milestone	Date
LDD	6/1/2026

Whitebox	6/8/20026
Initial Gameplay	6/22/2026
Gameplay Complete	7/6/2026
Aesthetics	7/13/2026
Launch	7/19/2026

Level Overview

Overview Map

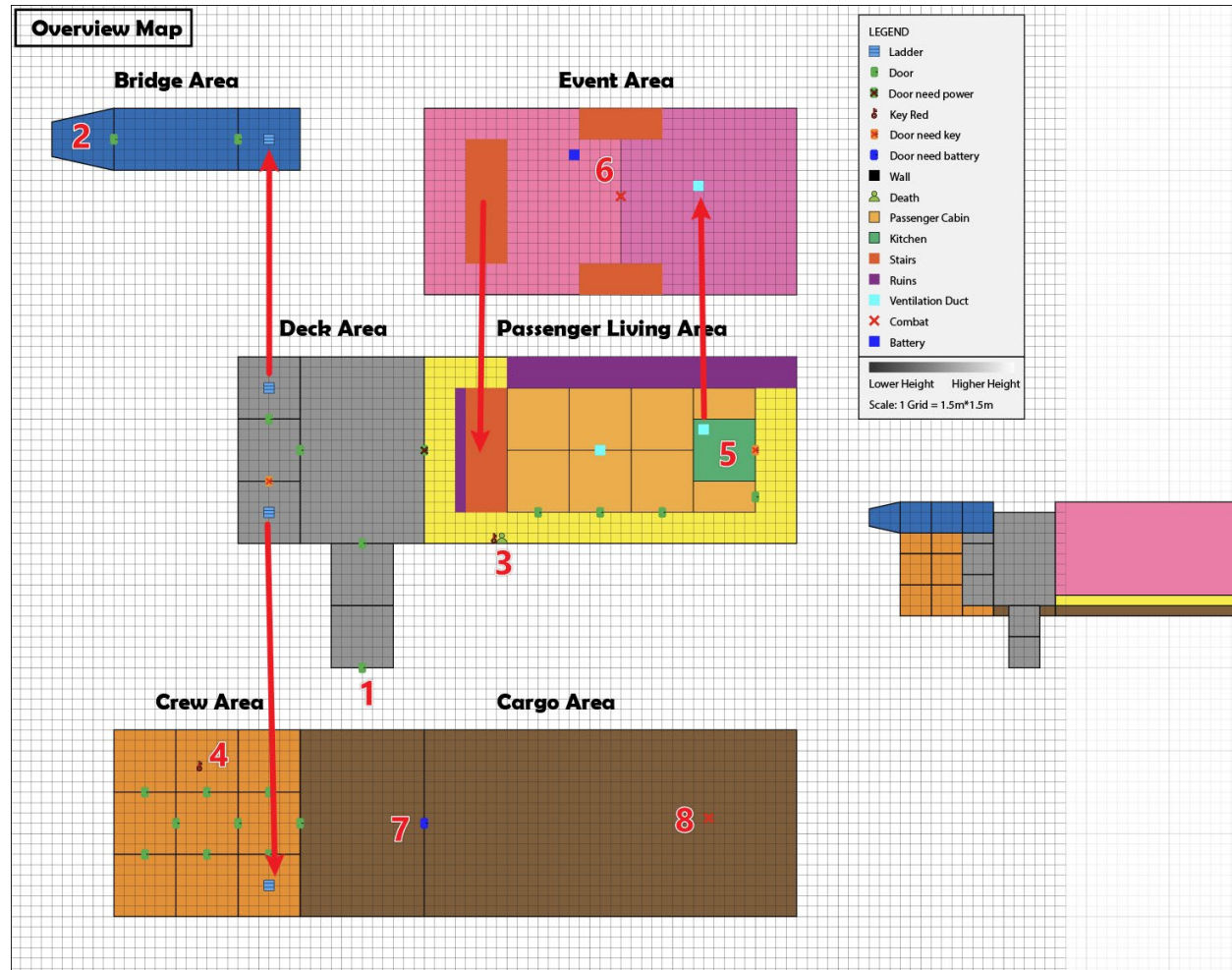


Figure 1: Overview Map

Map Label	Gameplay Summary
1	Board the cruise ship and enter the main deck area, only to find myself in a state of weightlessness and darkness.
2	Reach the bridge area, the backup power switch is activated; lighting and gravity are restored to normal. The doors to passenger living area open.
3	Reach the passenger living area, explore the passenger cabins. Discover a crew member's body and the key to the crew area.
4	Explore the crew area and find the kitchen key.
5	Enter the kitchen and proceed to the event area via the ventilation ducts.
6	Combat has broken out in the event area. Find the battery.
7	Use the battery to open the cargo area door.
8	Fight the final battle in the cargo area.

Level Details

Detail Maps

Section 1: Deck Area

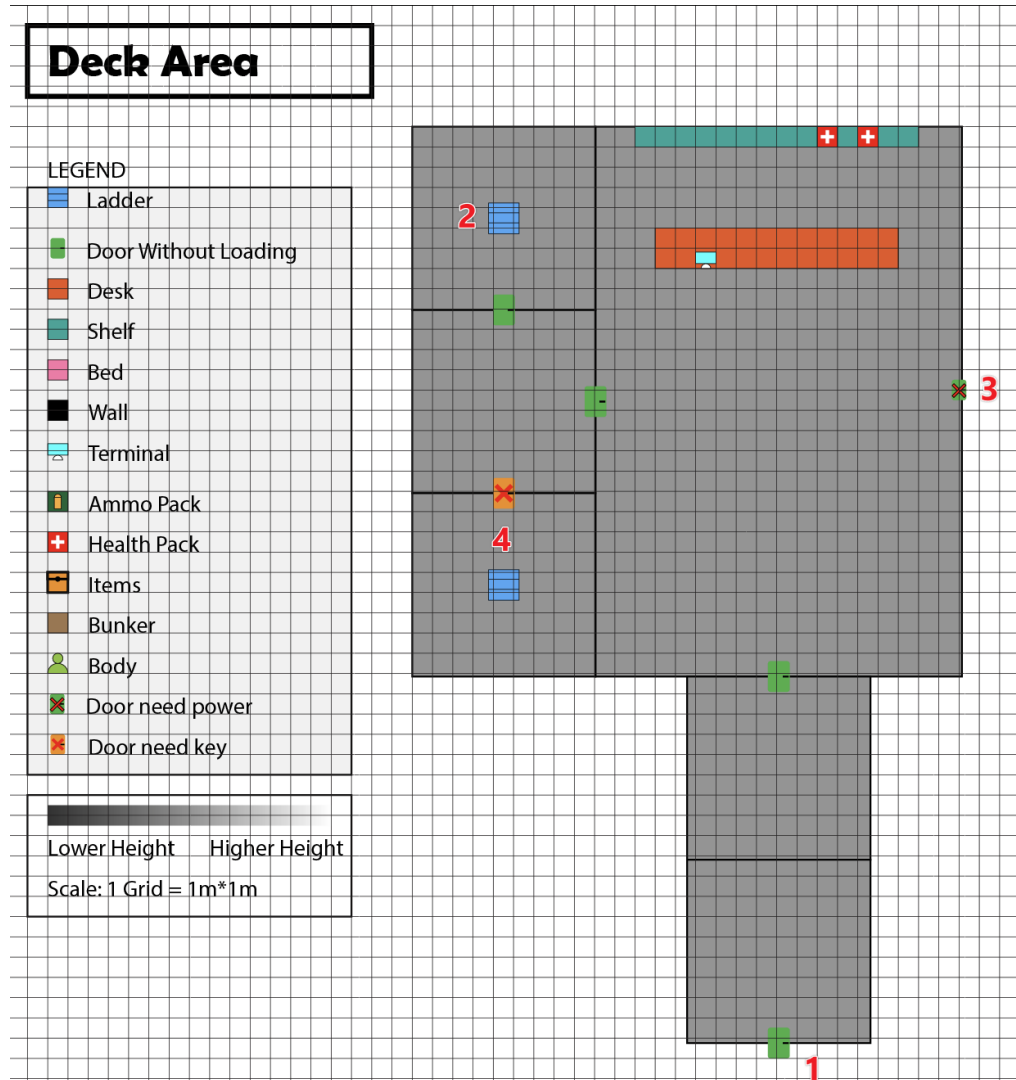


Figure 2: Deck area

Map Label / Stage	Event Summary	Event Details
1	Aboard the spaceship and arrive at the main hall of the deck area.	The hall was dimly lit and weightless; a flashlight was needed.
2	Players must first proceed to the Bridge area to activate the backup power supply.	The way to the bridge is unlocked.

3	Players need to turn on the backup power before they can open this door to the passenger area.	Locked at first.
4	Players need to find the key to open the door leading to the crew area.	Locked at first.

Section 2: Bridge Area

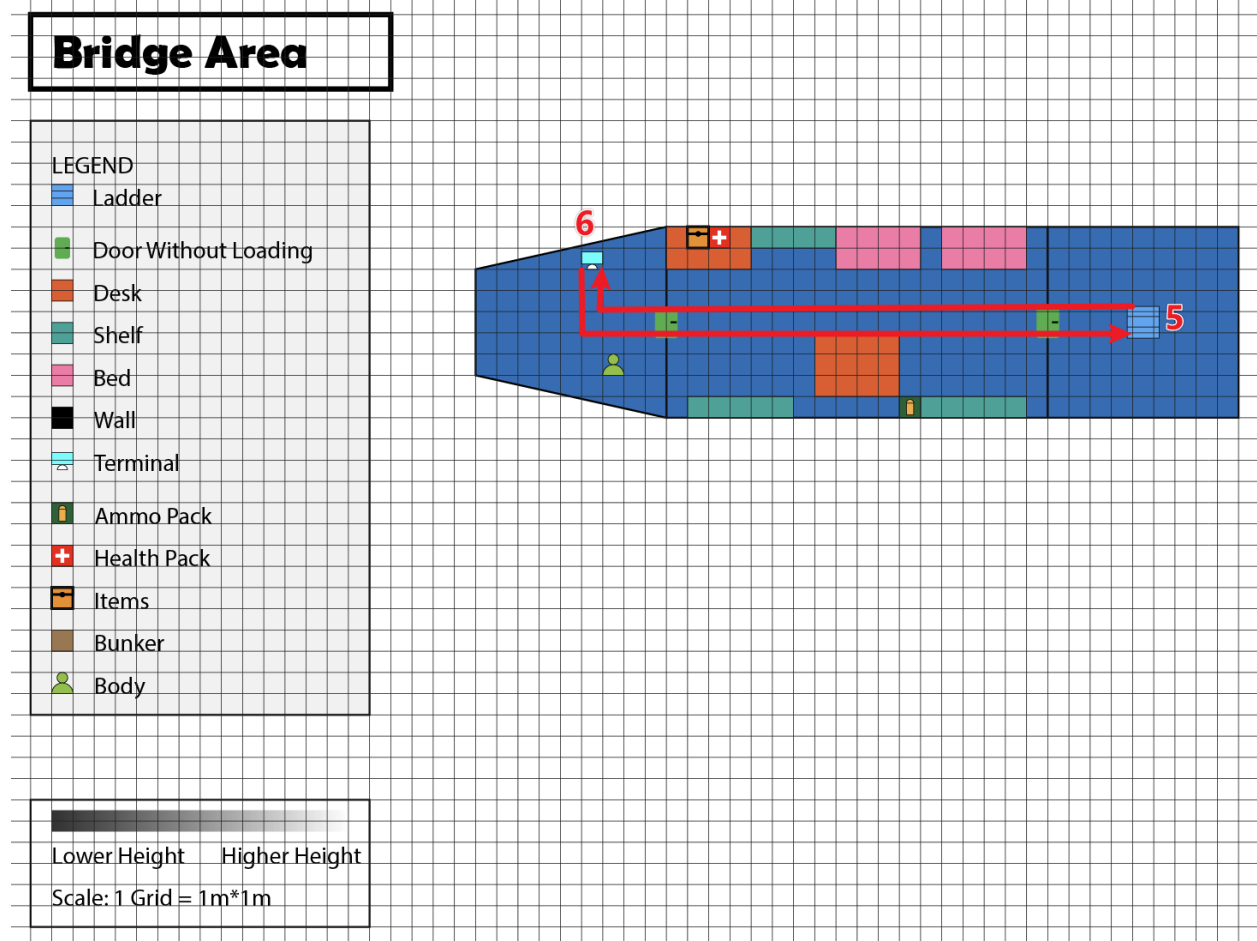


Figure 3: Bridge Area

Map Label / Stage	Event Summary	Event Details
5	Come from the deck area.	Climb the ladder.
6	Activate the terminal to power up the ship.	Unlock the door to the passenger area.

Section 3: Passenger Area

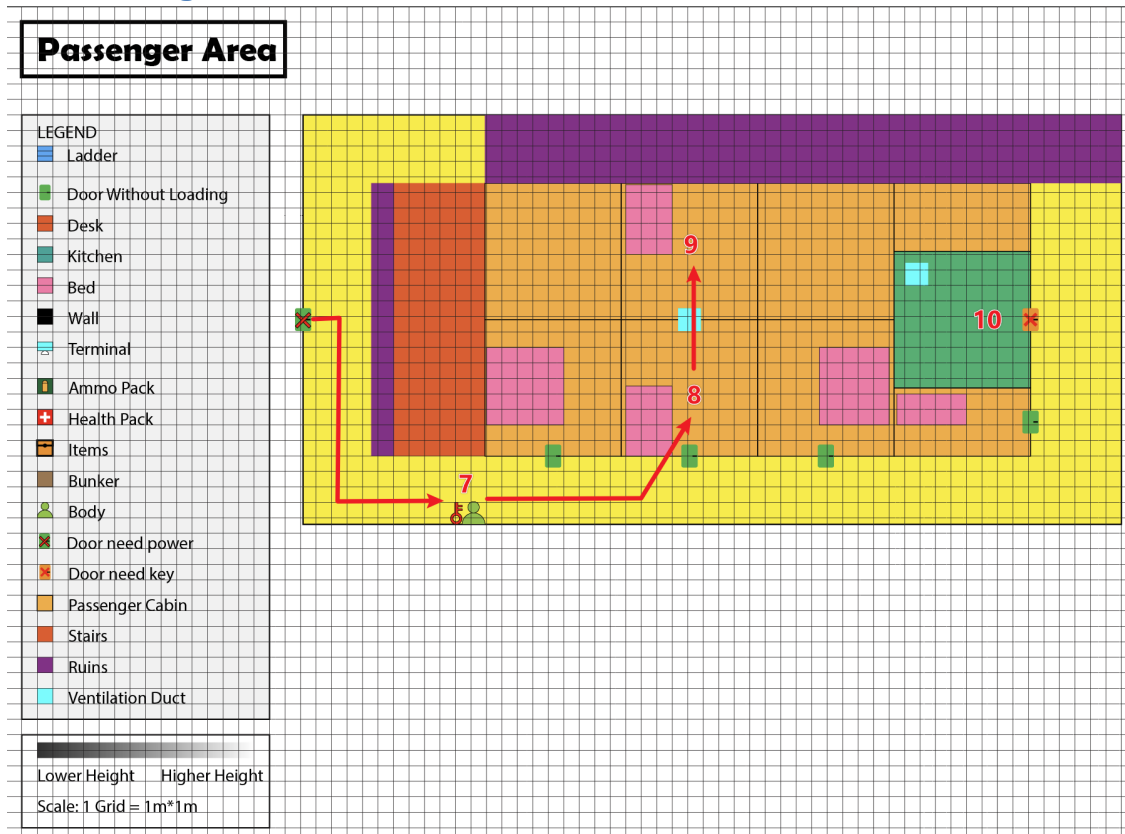


Figure 4: Passenger Area

Map Label / Stage	Event Summary	Event Details
7	Find a body with key.	The key is to unlock the door to the crew area.
8	Go inside the passenger cabins.	Interact with some environmental storytelling. Including scenes, documents, bodies.
9	Go into a secret cabin through ventilation ducts.	Interact with some environmental storytelling. Including scenes, documents, bodies.
10	The locked kitchen, there is a ventilation through the event area.	The door is locked, need to find a key.

Section 4: Crew Area

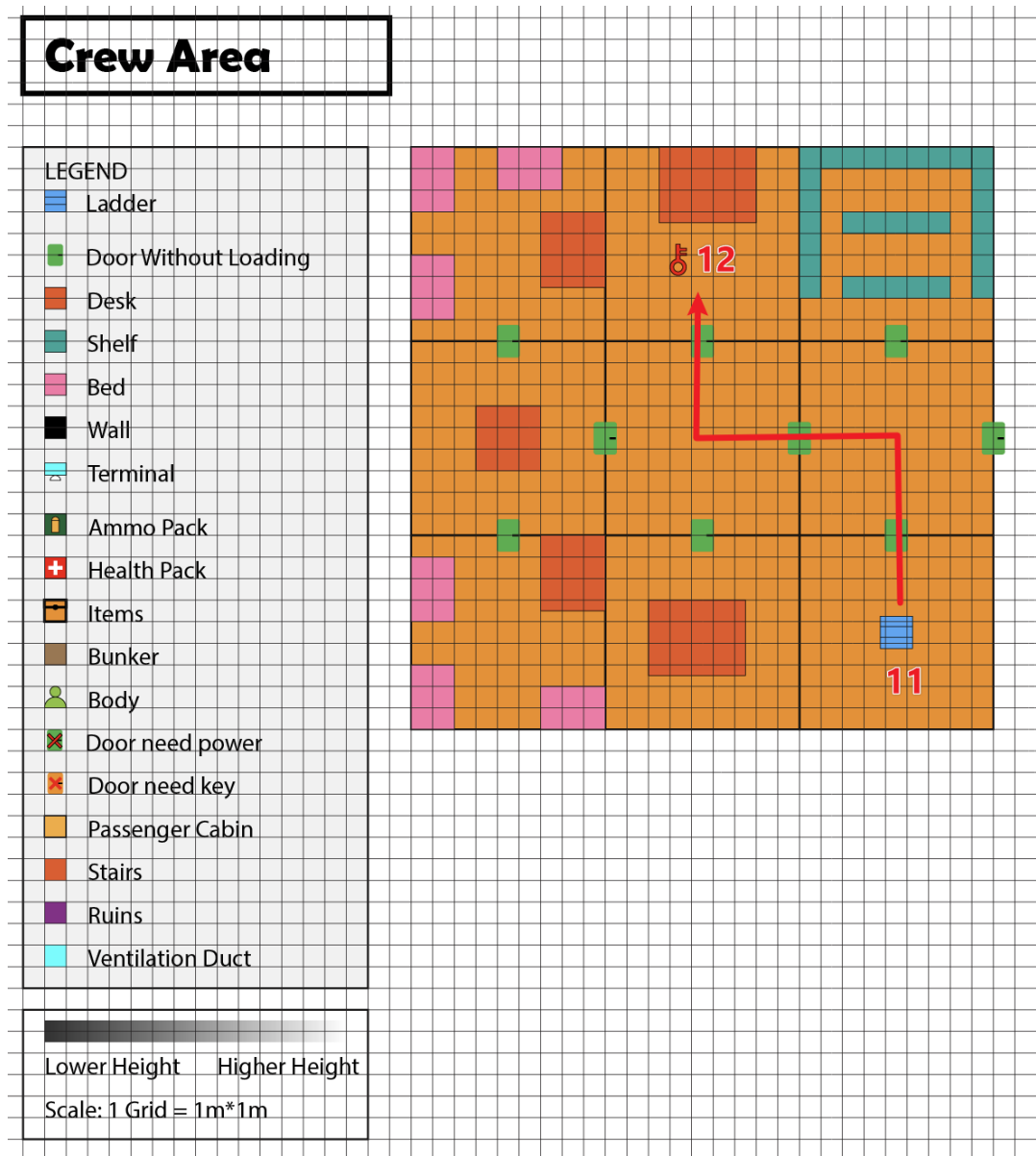


Figure 5: Crew Area

Map Label / Stage	Event Summary	Event Details
11	Come from the deck area.	Climb down the ladder.
12	Find the key to the kitchen.	To unlock the kitchen.

Section 5: Event Area

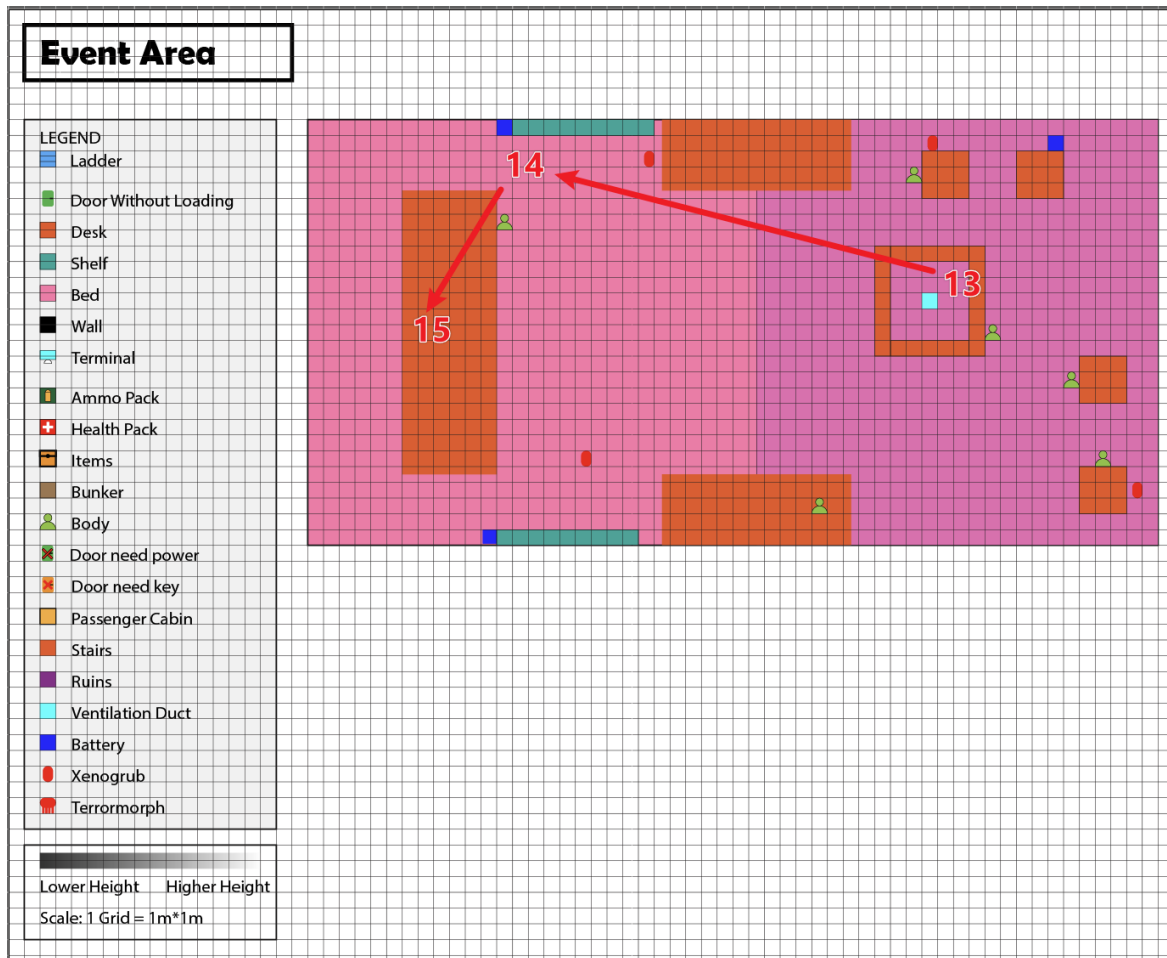


Figure 6: Event Area

Map Label / Stage	Event Summary	Event Details
13	Climb from the ventilation duct.	
14	Collect 3 batteries.	Four xenogrubs hide in the dark to attack player.
15	Go through the grand stairs back to the passenger area.	Only can go through in one direction.

Section 6: Cargo Area

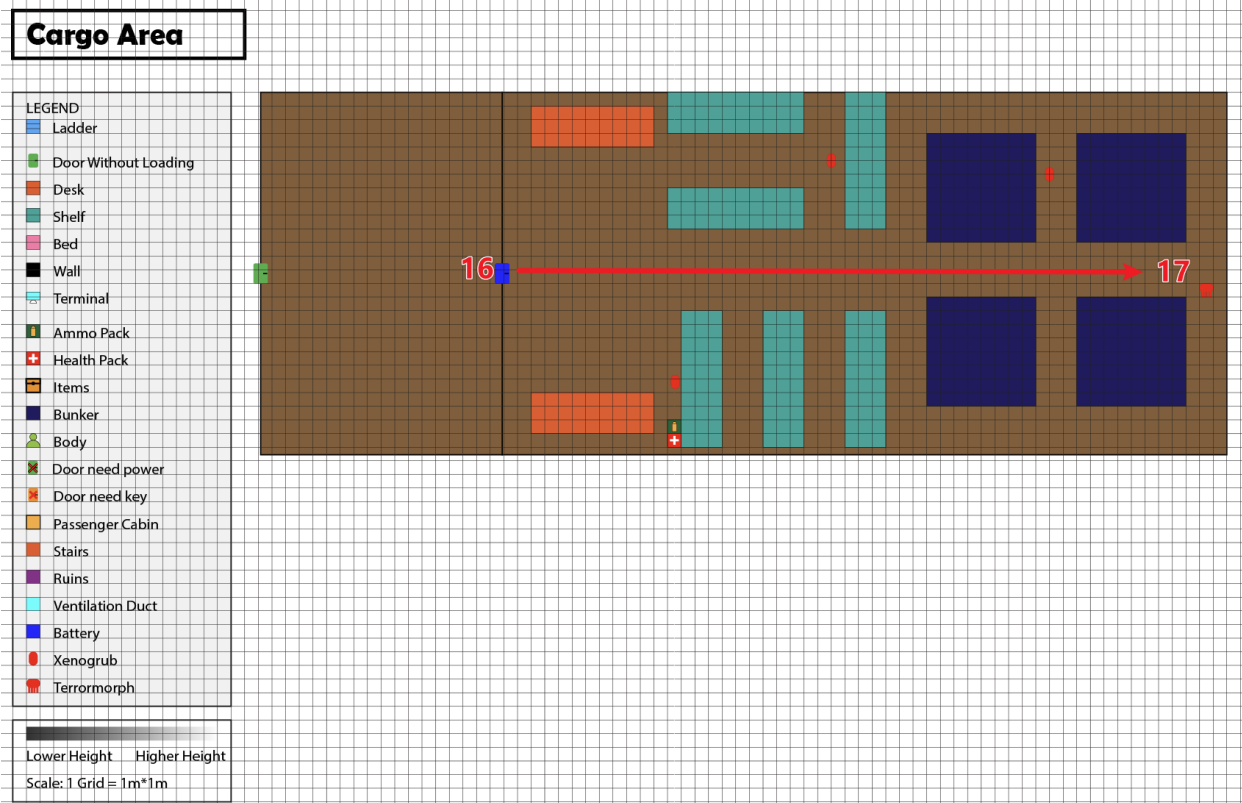


Figure 7: Cargo Area

Map Label / Stage	Event Summary	Event Details
16	Use 3 batteries collected from event area to unlock the door.	
17	Go inside the cargo area, collect fuel, while fighting with big enemies.	There are 3 xenogrubs and one powerful terrormorph in the room.

Skill Progression Chart

	Start 0	Deck Area	Bridge Area	Hallway	Passenger Living Area Passenger Cabins	Kitchen	Crew Area	Event Area	Cargo Area
Basic Movements									
Walk		E	H	X	X	X	X	X	X
Run		E	H	X	X	X	X	X	X
Jump		E	H	X	X	X	X	X	X
Crouch		E	E	H	E	H	E	H	H
Basic Skills									
Unlock				E			E		E
Hacking					E				
Scan Environment		E	E	E	E	E	E	E	E
Combat								E	H
Secret Button						E			
Pickpocket				E	E	E	E	E	E
Weapons									
Grendel								E	H
Ember								E	H
Rescue Axe								E	H
Health									
Health pack								E	H
Enemies									
Terrormorph								E	H
Kreet Stalker								E	H
Xenogrub								E	H
	0.00	2.00	4.00	6.00	8.00	10.00	12.00	14.00	16.00

	Legend			
	E	M	H	X
New skills	Intro	Reinforce	Master	
Starting Skills (START)	Beginner	Advanced	Expert	Master
Challenges	Easy	Medium	Hard	Legendary

Aesthetic References

An abandoned luxury space liner, strewn with corpses and bearing the scars of battle. The upper decks feature a lavish, cruise-ship aesthetic but in darkness and ruin. The lower decks consist of industrial-style crew quarters.

Visual Theme 1: Luxury Ocean liner



Figure 8: Luxury ocean liner style 1



Figure 9: Luxury ocean liner style 2

Visual Theme 2: Industrial spaceship interior**Figure 10: industrial spaceship style 1****Figure 11: Industrial spaceship interior 2**

References

[Cover Image] B. MacDonald, "Terror sets sail on the Ghost Ship for Halloween 2011 [Updated]," *Los Angeles Times*, Jun. 25, 2011. <https://www.latimes.com/travel/deals/la-trb-ghost-ship-halloween-haunted-attraction-06201123-story.html> (accessed Jun. 01, 2026).

[1] "Titanic: Project 401," *Titanichg.com*, 2015. <https://titanichg.com/project-401>

[2] J. Spry, "'If ever there's a movie where I got everything right, it was 'Alien': How Oscar winner Roger Christian made 'Alien: Earth' feel like a classic (exclusive)," *Space*, Aug. 27, 2025. <https://www.space.com/entertainment/alien-earth-how-oscar-winning-set-designer-roger-christians-original-alien-work-lives-on-exclusive> (accessed Jun. 02, 2026).

Appendices

Appendix B: Context Detail

General Context

This level consists of a standalone spacecraft facility situated in deep space, which players can discover and explore during their interstellar travels.

Backstory

While traveling through the stars in their spaceship, the player suddenly realized—to their dismay—that they had forgotten to refuel the vessel after waking up that morning. Consequently, they sent out a distress signal to the nearest ship. However, this massive interstellar cruise liner failed to respond; at this critical moment, the player boarded the liner in search of aid, only to discover that the entire vessel had already been plunged into darkness.

Aftermath

Players can acquire various resources and rewards and uncover the truth behind the events that transpired on this cruise ship.

Appendix E: Development Risks

Map Label	Description/Mitigation	Type	Priority
6	Large-scale luxury ocean liner environments are difficult to realize within Stanfield's ship cells.	Mesh	High
8	Designing a boss fight in a confined space is difficult. The monsters' AI might be broken.	Script	High

Appendix F: Key Asset Needs

Description	Type	Priority
Deluxe Classical Interior Decoration Art Assets	Mesh	High
Ship Cabin Art Assets	Mesh	Low
Monster Actors	Actor	High